

WHO CONTROLS BITCOIN?

A Deep Research Report on the World's Top 20 Biggest Bitcoin Holders

FILE 2 OF 3 · THE INSTITUTIONS

Category 3: ETF Issuers · Category 4: Public Companies

This file covers the institutional powerhouses that turned Bitcoin into a mainstream financial asset — the ETF giants that opened the floodgates to trillions in institutional capital, and the boldest public companies that put Bitcoin on their balance sheets and changed the way corporations think about treasury management forever.

RESEARCHED & AUTHORED BY

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NBZ Research Division · May 2026

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Each entity profile covers: full company background · 8 key people with complete biographies · Bitcoin acquisition and trade history · current holdings and USD value · market impact analysis · diagrams where relevant.

CATEGORY 3

ETF ISSUERS

THE INSTITUTIONAL GATEKEEPERS

06 · BlackRock (iShares IBIT) · 07 · Fidelity (FBTC) · 08 · Grayscale (GBTC)

ENTITY #06 · ETF ISSUER · CATEGORY 3

BlackRock — iShares Bitcoin Trust (IBIT)

HOLDINGS	AUM	PARENT AUM	ETF LAUNCHED
~814,000+ BTC	~\$66 Billion	\$14.2 Trillion	Jan 11, 2024
Via IBIT ETF	iShares Bitcoin Trust	Total BlackRock	Nasdaq: IBIT

COMPANY BACKGROUND

BlackRock is the largest asset management company in human history, overseeing approximately \$14.2 trillion in total assets under management as of Q1 2026 — a figure that exceeds the GDP of every nation on Earth except the United States and China. Founded in 1988 by Larry Fink and seven partners from First Boston Corporation, BlackRock built its empire on a foundation of risk management, bond markets, and the world's largest ETF platform, iShares. Through iShares, BlackRock manages trillions in index-tracking funds that give everyday investors and institutions alike access to every major asset class in the world. Bitcoin, as of January 2024, became the newest and fastest-growing addition to that empire.

BlackRock's entry into Bitcoin was the single most significant institutional event in crypto history. When the world's largest asset manager — long a pillar of the traditional financial establishment — filed for a spot Bitcoin ETF on June 16, 2023, it sent an unmistakable signal to every institutional investor on Earth: Bitcoin is now a legitimate asset class. The filing triggered a wave of similar applications from Fidelity, Invesco, Ark Invest, and six other firms. Bitcoin surged 25% in the weeks that followed.

The iShares Bitcoin Trust (IBIT) was approved by the SEC on January 10, 2024, and began trading the following day. It grew faster than any ETF in financial history, crossing \$10 billion AUM in its first week, \$50 billion within months, and \$100 billion AUM by October 2025 — reaching that milestone in just 435 days after launch. For context, it took gold ETFs approximately 1,000 days to reach \$100 billion. IBIT has become not just a financial product but a cultural watershed: the moment Wall Street fully embraced Bitcoin.

8 KEY PEOPLE — FULL BIOGRAPHIES

Larry Fink

Chairman & Chief Executive Officer — Co-Founder

Laurence Douglas Fink was born on November 2, 1952, in Van Nuys, California, into a middle-class Jewish family. His father, Frederick, ran a shoe store; his mother, Lila, was an English professor at California State University, Northridge. This working-class San Fernando Valley upbringing shaped Fink's character — he was academically ambitious but never privileged, and the combination gave him both drive and groundedness. He earned a Bachelor of Arts in Political Science from UCLA in 1974, then stayed on for an MBA in real estate from UCLA Anderson School of Management in 1976. His MBA thesis focused on real estate investment, an interest that foreshadowed his future as one of the world's great architects of mortgage-backed securities markets. Fink joined First Boston Corporation in 1976 as a bond trader and rose meteorically — by age 28 he was one of the youngest Managing Directors in the firm's history, and his team generated approximately \$1 billion in profits over several years by pioneering the US mortgage-backed securities market. Then came the catastrophic moment that defined him. In 1986, Fink's team made a devastating misprediction on interest rate movements, resulting in a loss of approximately \$100 million in a single quarter. He later described it simply: 'I screwed up. And it was bad.' The loss ended his career at First Boston. He was effectively forced out — humiliated in an industry that remembered everything. Two years later, in 1988, Fink co-founded BlackRock with seven partners, operating initially under the umbrella of The Blackstone Group, which provided a \$5 million loan in exchange for a 50% equity stake. BlackRock split from Blackstone in 1994 and went public in 1999. In 2009, the acquisition of Barclays Global Investors made BlackRock the world's largest asset manager. Fink's Bitcoin journey is one of the most dramatic reversals of opinion in financial history. In 2017, he publicly called Bitcoin 'an index of money laundering.' In 2021, he described himself as 'a student of Bitcoin.' By 2024, he was personally promoting IBIT to sovereign wealth funds. In 2025, he described Bitcoin as 'an asset of fear' — meaning investors flee to it when governments debase their currencies. His full reversal is the most consequential individual change of mind in crypto history. Fink married Lori Weider in 1974. They have three children. He serves as Co-Chair of the Board of Trustees of the World Economic Forum.

Robert S. Kapito

President & Co-Founder

Robert Kapito was born in 1957 in Monticello, New York. He studied at the Wharton School of Business at the University of Pennsylvania, graduating with a BS in Economics, then earned an MBA from Harvard Business School. He met Larry Fink at First Boston, where they worked together building the mortgage-backed securities business, and was one of the seven partners who co-founded BlackRock in 1988. As President since 2007, Kapito oversees BlackRock's investment strategies, client businesses, technology and operations, and risk and quantitative analysis divisions. He is Fink's most trusted long-term partner and the operational spine of the firm. He approved and championed the IBIT Bitcoin ETF initiative alongside Fink.

Samara Cohen

Chief Investment Officer — ETF and Index Investments

Samara Cohen is the executive most directly responsible for the day-to-day management and strategic direction of IBIT and all of BlackRock's ETF and index investment products. She has been one of BlackRock's most visible public advocates for Bitcoin as a portfolio diversification tool, appearing regularly on CNBC, Bloomberg, and at institutional investor conferences to explain IBIT's mechanics and investment rationale. Under her stewardship, the iShares ETF platform has grown to over \$5 trillion in global AUM, with IBIT representing its most spectacular individual product launch.

Rob Goldstein

Chief Operating Officer & Head of BlackRock Solutions

Rob Goldstein joined BlackRock in 1994 and has served as COO since 2018. He heads BlackRock Solutions, the firm's technology platform that operates the Aladdin risk management system — essentially the operating system of institutional finance globally, used to manage over \$20 trillion in assets for external clients. Goldstein's Aladdin platform provided the institutional-grade risk management infrastructure that made BlackRock's Bitcoin ETF custody arrangements trustworthy to the most conservative institutional investors.

Martin Small

Chief Financial Officer

Martin Small has served as CFO of BlackRock since January 2023, overseeing the firm's financial strategy and reporting. He manages the accounting and revenue recognition for IBIT and BlackRock's broader digital assets business. IBIT generates approximately \$200 million annually in management fees at its 0.25% annual fee rate applied to \$66 billion in AUM — making Bitcoin a genuinely material revenue contribution to BlackRock's overall income.

Christopher Meade

Chief Legal Officer

Christopher Meade has served as BlackRock's Chief Legal Officer since 2016. He previously served as General Counsel of the United States Department of the Treasury — a background that gave him extraordinary insight into the SEC approval process for IBIT. His understanding of both the regulatory framework and the government's internal decision-making processes was instrumental in structuring IBIT's application in a way that could ultimately secure SEC approval after years of previous rejections for other applicants.

Rachel Lord

Senior Managing Director, Head of International

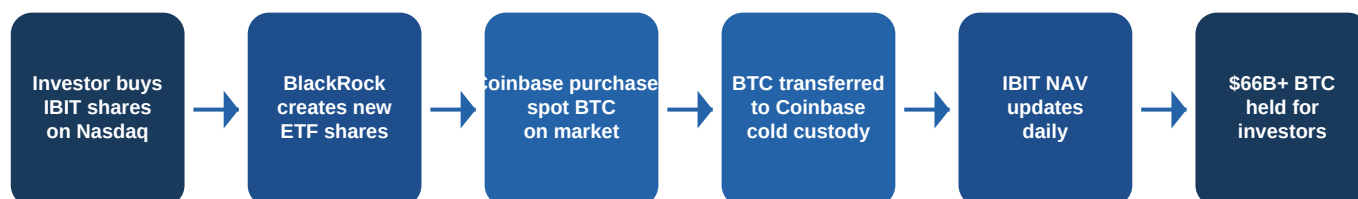
Rachel Lord leads BlackRock's international business operations, overseeing the expansion of IBIT and other digital asset products beyond the US market. Under her leadership, BlackRock has pursued Bitcoin ETF approvals in European and Asian markets, seeking to replicate IBIT's US success globally. The international expansion of Bitcoin ETF products is expected to unlock the next major wave of institutional inflows into Bitcoin.

Susan Wagner

Co-Founder & Board Director

Susan Wagner was one of the original eight co-founders of BlackRock in 1988, working alongside Fink and Kapito from the very beginning at First Boston. She retired from her operating role as COO in 2012 but remains a Board Director, representing the founding generation's oversight of the firm's strategic direction. Her personal stake in BlackRock, built over 36 years, makes her one of the most quietly wealthy figures in American finance.

HOW BLACKROCK'S IBIT WORKS — FLOW DIAGRAM



Every dollar invested in IBIT triggers a chain of real Bitcoin purchases. Coinbase acts as the authorised participant and custodian, holding the underlying BTC in cold storage on behalf of all IBIT shareholders.

BITCOIN ACQUISITION HISTORY — IBIT

- ▲ **BUY** Jun 16, 2023 · FILING ONLY · \$~\$26,000/BTC · Total: N/A — *BlackRock files spot Bitcoin ETF application. Market surges 25%.*
- ▲ **BUY** Jan 11, 2024 · First week inflows · \$46,000/BTC · Total: \$1B+ Day 1 — *IBIT launches. Fastest ETF launch in history. \$10B in first week.*
- ▲ **BUY** Mar 2024 · Ongoing inflows · \$60,000–\$70,000/BTC · Total: \$50B AUM milestone — *Bitcoin halving anticipation drives massive institutional demand.*
- ▲ **BUY** Jun 2024 · Ongoing · \$60,000/BTC · Total: \$20B+ inflows YTD — *IBIT overtakes Grayscale's GBTC to become world's largest Bitcoin fund.*
- ▲ **BUY** Q3 2025 · Ongoing accumulation · \$95,000–\$122,000/BTC · Total: \$80B+ AUM — *Bitcoin peaks above \$122K. IBIT AUM surges.*
- ▲ **BUY** Oct 2025 · Historic milestone · \$90,000+/BTC · Total: \$100B AUM — *IBIT crosses \$100 billion AUM. 435 days from launch.*
- ◆ **NOTE** Q1 2026 · ~814,000 BTC in custody. \$935M in crypto ETF inflows in Q1 2026 alone. World's largest Bitcoin fund.

MARKET IMPACT

BlackRock's IBIT is the most transformative financial product in the history of digital assets. It did not merely open a door for institutional Bitcoin investment — it demolished the wall. When the world's largest asset manager created a Bitcoin product and began promoting it to sovereign wealth funds, pension funds, and endowments globally, it permanently altered the perception of Bitcoin's risk profile in institutional investment committees everywhere.

IBIT generates approximately \$200 million in annual fee revenue for BlackRock at current AUM levels, making Bitcoin a genuine profit centre for the firm. This financial alignment means BlackRock now has a strong institutional incentive to advocate for Bitcoin's continued adoption, regulatory clarity, and price appreciation — making it one of Bitcoin's most powerful institutional lobbyists.

ENTITY #07 · ETF ISSUER · CATEGORY 3

Fidelity Investments — Fidelity Wise Origin Bitcoin Fund (FBTC)

HOLDINGS	FBTC AUM	TOTAL AUM	ETF LAUNCHED
~452,000 BTC	~\$36 Billion	\$7.1 Trillion	Jan 11, 2024
Via FBTC ETF	Fidelity Bitcoin ETF	All Fidelity funds	Ticker: FBTC

COMPANY BACKGROUND

Fidelity Investments is one of the oldest, largest, and most respected financial services firms in the United States. Founded in 1946 in Boston, Massachusetts by Edward C. Johnson II as Fidelity Management and Research Company, it has remained a privately held, family-controlled enterprise for its entire 80-year history — a remarkable distinction for a company of its size. Fidelity manages approximately \$7.1 trillion in total assets as of 2025, serves 51 million individual investors, and employs approximately 80,000 people worldwide.

Unlike BlackRock, which came to Bitcoin late after years of scepticism, Fidelity was a genuine, early, and committed Bitcoin believer — driven primarily by the personal conviction of its CEO, Abigail Johnson. Fidelity was experimenting with Bitcoin mining in its own offices as early as 2015, launched Fidelity Digital Assets (its Bitcoin custody and trading service for institutions) in October 2018, and applied to the SEC for a spot Bitcoin ETF years before others. The Fidelity Wise Origin Bitcoin Fund (FBTC) launched on January 11, 2024, the same day as BlackRock's IBIT, and quickly became the second-largest Bitcoin ETF in the world.

Fidelity's Bitcoin story is unique among all ETF issuers because it is not merely a financial product — it is a conviction that runs through the firm's DNA, driven from the top. In 2017, Abigail Johnson revealed at the Consensus conference that Fidelity employees could pay for food in the company cafeteria using Bitcoin. She also confirmed she personally owns Bitcoin. These were not PR stunts — they reflected genuine, years-long institutional commitment to digital assets.

8 KEY PEOPLE — FULL BIOGRAPHIES

Abigail Pierrepont Johnson

Chairwoman, CEO & President — The Bitcoin Believer

Abigail Johnson was born on December 19, 1961, in Boston, Massachusetts, into one of the most consequential families in American financial history. Her grandfather, Edward C. Johnson II, founded Fidelity Investments in 1946. Her father, Edward C. Johnson III — known universally as 'Ned' — transformed it into a mutual fund titan. Abigail grew up in Boston, attending private schools, spending her youth figure skating and skiing. Despite being the heir to a financial empire, her path into the business was anything but entitled. She received a Bachelor of Arts in Art History from Hobart and William Smith Colleges in 1984 — not finance, not economics — reflecting an intellectual breadth that would later inform her willingness to look at assets like Bitcoin that conventional financial thinkers dismissed. While completing her art history degree, she interned at Fidelity every summer, drawn to the trading room's energy. She earned an MBA from Harvard Business School in 1988 and joined Fidelity as an analyst and portfolio manager the same year — not in a sinecure created for the owner's daughter, but in a genuine junior role. She rose through merit: President of Fidelity Asset Management in 2001, Head of Retail, Workplace and Institutional Business in 2005, President of Fidelity Investments in 2012, CEO in 2014, Chairman in 2016. Her net worth is estimated at \$35.6 billion, making her the wealthiest person in Massachusetts. She and her family own approximately 40% of Fidelity's shares. Abigail Johnson's Bitcoin story began around 2014-2015, when she started quietly directing Fidelity's technology team to experiment with Bitcoin mining. By 2017, she was speaking publicly about her personal Bitcoin holdings and Fidelity's mining experiments at the Consensus conference in New York — one of the most surprising moments in institutional crypto history. She described Bitcoin as 'something I find fascinating' and showed a genuine intellectual engagement with the technology that was entirely absent from her Wall Street peers. Her early conviction, expressed when Bitcoin was worth a few thousand dollars, was vindicated spectacularly. She serves on the boards of MIT, SIFMA, and the Financial Services Forum.

Edward C. Johnson III — 'Ned'

Former Chairman & CEO (Retired), Founder's Son

Ned Johnson was born in 1930 and served as Fidelity's Chairman and CEO from 1977 until handing the reins to his daughter in 2014 and 2016 respectively. Under his stewardship, Fidelity grew from a mid-sized mutual fund company into a \$5 trillion giant. He was famously eclectic — deeply interested in Buddhism and Asian philosophy alongside Western finance. His willingness to explore unconventional ideas seeded a culture at Fidelity that made Abigail's Bitcoin exploration possible. He passed away in March 2022 at age 91, having lived long enough to see his daughter position Fidelity at the forefront of digital asset adoption.

Kevin Gallagher

Chief Operating Officer, Fidelity Investments

Kevin Gallagher oversees day-to-day operations across Fidelity's multiple business units, including the digital assets division. His role is critical in maintaining the operational infrastructure that supports FBTC's Bitcoin custody — Fidelity uniquely self-custodies its Bitcoin rather than using an external custodian like Coinbase, through its wholly owned subsidiary Fidelity Digital Assets Services (FDAS). This self-custody model is both a differentiator and a significant operational responsibility.

Tom Jessop

President, Fidelity Digital Assets (FDAS)

Tom Jessop leads Fidelity Digital Assets, the subsidiary responsible for all of Fidelity's digital asset custody, trading, and institutional service offerings. Before joining Fidelity in 2018, Jessop was at Goldman Sachs where he ran digital asset strategy. His move from Goldman to Fidelity's crypto arm in 2018 was one of the earliest high-profile Wall Street moves into institutional crypto. FDAS is the custodian for FBTC's 452,000 BTC — meaning Fidelity, unlike every other ETF issuer, holds its own Bitcoin without outsourcing custody.

Greg Friedman

Head of ETF Management and Strategy

Greg Friedman oversees Fidelity's ETF product strategy, including FBTC. His team manages the fund's daily operations, NAV calculations, creation and redemption mechanisms, and the relationships with authorised participants. Fidelity's ETF business has grown to over \$125 billion in total assets as of mid-2025, with FBTC as its flagship product.

Jurrien Timmer

Director of Global Macro, Fidelity

Jurrien Timmer is Fidelity's most public-facing Bitcoin intellectual — the strategist who has done more than anyone else at the firm to build the analytical framework for thinking about Bitcoin as a macro asset. He developed Fidelity's 'Bitcoin as digital gold' thesis and has published extensively on Bitcoin's supply scarcity model, its correlation with global liquidity cycles, and its long-term value proposition as an inflation hedge. His research has been widely cited by institutional investors building their own Bitcoin investment cases.

Christine Donahue

Head of Marketing, Fidelity

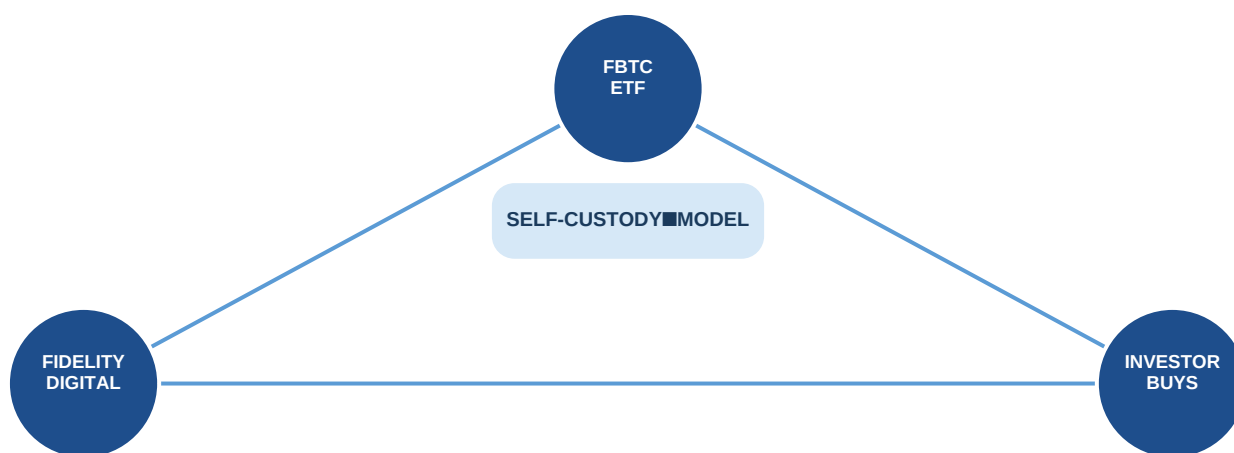
Christine Donahue has overseen the marketing strategy for FBTC's launch and ongoing promotion. The challenge of marketing a Bitcoin ETF to Fidelity's traditional client base — pension fund managers, 401(k) plan administrators, and conservative retail investors — required a delicate balance: communicating Bitcoin's potential without alarming the compliance-conscious institutional gatekeepers who control asset allocation decisions.

Eric Winograd

Chief US Economist, Fidelity

Winograd provides the macroeconomic context that frames Fidelity's investment products including FBTC. His analysis of monetary policy, inflation, and currency dynamics forms the intellectual backdrop for Fidelity's messaging around Bitcoin as a portfolio diversifier and inflation hedge — core arguments used in the marketing and institutional promotion of FBTC.

HOW FIDELITY IS DIFFERENT — THE SELF-CUSTODY MODEL



Unlike BlackRock which uses Coinbase as custodian, Fidelity self-custodies its Bitcoin through Fidelity Digital Assets Services — its own wholly owned subsidiary. This makes Fidelity the only major Bitcoin ETF issuer that controls its own custody chain.

BITCOIN ACQUISITION & HISTORY

- ◆ **NOTE** 2014–2015 · Fidelity begins internal Bitcoin mining experiments. Abigail Johnson personally directs exploration.
- ◆ **NOTE** 2017 · Johnson reveals at Consensus conference that Fidelity has been mining BTC and employees can pay with Bitcoin in the cafeteria.
- ▲ **BUY** Oct 2018 · Institutional launch · \$Varied/BTC · Total: N/A — *Fidelity Digital Assets launches custody & trading for institutional clients. Years ahead of competitors.*
- ◆ **NOTE** 2019–2023 · Multiple Bitcoin ETF applications to SEC. All rejected. Fidelity continues building infrastructure anyway.
- ◆ **NOTE** 2021 · Fidelity allows 401(k) retirement plan participants to allocate up to 20% of their balance to Bitcoin — a first for any major retirement platform.

▲ **BUY** Jan 11, 2024 · FBTC launches · \$\$46,000/BTC · Total: \$1B+ inflows Week 1 — *Among first spot Bitcoin ETFs approved. Immediate massive demand.*

▲ **BUY** 2024–2025 · Ongoing inflows · \$\$50,000–\$122,000/BTC · Total: \$21B+ AUM by 2025 — *FBTC becomes second-largest Bitcoin ETF globally behind IBIT.*

◆ **NOTE** May 2026 · ~452,000 BTC in self-custody via FDAS. ~\$36B AUM.

MARKET IMPACT

Fidelity's significance in Bitcoin's institutional history goes beyond its FBTC holdings. It was the first major financial institution to take Bitcoin seriously — years before BlackRock, Goldman Sachs, or any other establishment name. Abigail Johnson's personal conviction and willingness to build institutional infrastructure long before regulatory approval created the foundation upon which FBTC was built. The firm's self-custody model also demonstrates that institutional-grade Bitcoin custody does not require dependence on specialist crypto firms — a critical point for the most conservative institutional investors.

ENTITY #08 · ETF ISSUER / TRUST · CATEGORY 3

Grayscale Investments — Grayscale Bitcoin Trust (GBTC)

HOLDINGS	AUM	PEAK AUM	PARENT
~220,000 BTC	~\$17 Billion	\$40+ Billion	Digital Currency Group
GBTC fund	At current price	November 2021	Barry Silbert

COMPANY BACKGROUND

Grayscale Investments is the original institutional Bitcoin product — the company that, for nearly a decade, was the only regulated vehicle through which most institutional investors could gain Bitcoin exposure. Founded in 2013 by Barry Silbert as part of his Digital Currency Group (DCG) holding company, the Grayscale Bitcoin Trust (GBTC) launched in September 2013 as a private placement trust, becoming the first publicly traded Bitcoin vehicle in the US when it began trading over-the-counter in 2015. For years, it was the only way for pension funds, endowments, and registered investment advisors to hold Bitcoin in a familiar, regulated format.

At its peak in November 2021, GBTC held over 650,000 BTC and managed more than \$40 billion in assets. It was a monopoly — and it knew it. Grayscale charged a 2% annual management fee, one of the highest in the ETF industry, precisely because it had no competition. Then, on January 11, 2024, everything changed. The SEC approved eleven spot Bitcoin ETFs simultaneously. BlackRock launched IBIT at 0.25%. Fidelity launched FBTC at 0.25%. Investors who had been trapped in GBTC's expensive trust structure finally had a way out. The result was the most dramatic asset hemorrhage in ETF history: GBTC lost over \$20 billion in outflows in the first few months of 2024 alone. By mid-2026, holdings had fallen from 650,000 BTC to approximately 220,000 BTC.

Grayscale's GBTC story has a dramatic legal dimension. When the SEC repeatedly rejected Grayscale's application to convert GBTC from a trust into a proper spot ETF, Grayscale sued the SEC in 2022. In August 2023, a federal appeals court ruled decisively in Grayscale's favour, finding the SEC's rejection was 'arbitrary and capricious.' That court victory was the direct catalyst for the SEC's subsequent approval of all spot Bitcoin ETF applications in January 2024 — meaning Grayscale's legal battle inadvertently opened the door for BlackRock and Fidelity to launch the products that then devastated GBTC.

8 KEY PEOPLE — FULL BIOGRAPHIES

Barry Silbert

Founder & CEO, Digital Currency Group (GBTC's Parent Company)

Barry Silbert was born in 1977 in Gaithersburg, Maryland. He attended Emory University in Atlanta, Georgia, graduating in 1998 with a degree in finance. He began his career at Houlihan Lokey, a leading investment bank specialising in restructuring and M&A, where he spent several years learning the mechanics of distressed assets and corporate turnarounds. In 2004, he founded SecondMarket — a platform for trading illiquid assets like private company stock and bankruptcy claims. SecondMarket became one of the most important alternative trading platforms of the pre-IPO era, facilitating secondary market trading in companies like Facebook and Twitter before they went public. Nasdaq acquired SecondMarket in 2015 for an undisclosed sum. Silbert encountered Bitcoin in 2012 and immediately understood its significance as a new, illiquid asset class that needed better market infrastructure — exactly the problem he had solved with SecondMarket. He founded Bitcoin Investment Trust (later renamed Grayscale Bitcoin Trust) in 2013 and Digital Currency Group (DCG) in 2015 as a holding company for his crypto ventures. DCG has invested in over 200 crypto companies and built a portfolio that includes CoinDesk, Genesis (a crypto lending firm), Foundry (a mining operation), and Luno. Silbert's empire took heavy damage in 2022-2023 when Genesis Global Capital collapsed following the FTX implosion, triggering a messy legal and financial crisis. He emerged from the Genesis crisis, settled creditor claims, and has repositioned DCG and Grayscale for their next chapter.

Peter Mintzberg

CEO of Grayscale Investments (since August 15, 2024)

Peter Mintzberg joined Grayscale as CEO in August 2024, replacing Michael Sonnenshein who had stepped down. Mintzberg came directly from Goldman Sachs, where he served as Global Head of Strategy for Asset and Wealth Management — a senior strategic role at one of the world's most prestigious investment banks. He previously held positions at BlackRock, OppenheimerFunds, and Invesco — meaning he had direct experience at three of Grayscale's direct competitors before joining. His 20+ years of traditional asset management experience represents a deliberate strategic choice by Silbert: to professionalise Grayscale's management in the face of intensifying competition from established institutional players. His mission is to stop the bleeding from GBTC outflows and develop new products that compete with BlackRock and Fidelity's lower-cost offerings.

Michael Sonnenshein

Former CEO (2021–2024), The Man Who Sued the SEC

Michael Sonnenshein joined Grayscale in 2014 as an account executive after stints at Bank of America, Barclays, and JPMorgan Chase. He rose to become CEO in 2021 when Silbert stepped back, and his tenure is defined by one decision above all others: suing the SEC when it rejected Grayscale's ETF conversion application in 2022. It was a bold, legally risky move that the crypto industry applauded. He won. The August 2023 court victory was the pivotal legal moment in Bitcoin ETF history. The painful irony is that winning the lawsuit opened the market to competitors who then outcompeted GBTC. Sonnenshein stepped down in May 2024 'to pursue other interests.' His decade at Grayscale transformed a \$60 million trust into a \$30 billion institution.

Edward McGee

Chief Financial Officer

Edward McGee has been Grayscale's CFO for several years and served as principal executive officer in the interim period between Sonnenshein's departure and Mintzberg's arrival. As CFO, he manages the complex accounting of GBTC's daily NAV calculations, Bitcoin custody reconciliation, and the fee revenue that provides Grayscale's income. Despite the significant asset outflows, GBTC's 2% fee on remaining AUM still generates substantial revenue.

Craig Salm

Chief Legal Officer

Craig Salm has been Grayscale's legal architect throughout the SEC battles and regulatory challenges. He built and managed the legal strategy for the Grayscale vs. SEC case that eventually forced the approval of all spot Bitcoin ETFs. His work represents some of the most consequential securities litigation in the history of digital asset regulation.

David LaValle

Global Head of ETFs

David LaValle oversees Grayscale's broader ETF strategy beyond just GBTC, including the development of new digital asset products that can compete with BlackRock and Fidelity's growing lineup. Grayscale launched a Bitcoin Mini Trust at 0.15% — far cheaper than GBTC — specifically to recapture cost-sensitive investors.

Donald Porterfield

General Counsel

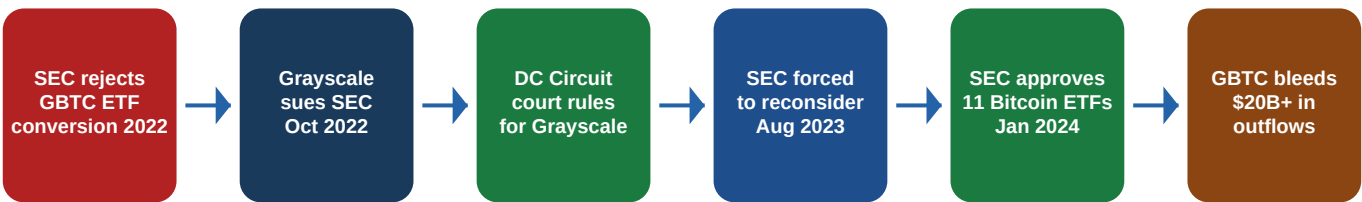
Porterfield handles Grayscale's day-to-day legal matters, regulatory compliance, and the ongoing legal complexities of managing publicly traded digital asset products under SEC oversight. His work has become significantly more demanding since GBTC's conversion to a full ETF structure.

Mark Shifke

Former CFO, DCG Level (Barry Silbert's Organisation)

Mark Shifke served at the DCG holding company level, managing the financial relationships between Silbert's various portfolio companies including Grayscale, Genesis, CoinDesk, and Foundry. The collapse of Genesis in 2023 created an extraordinarily complex financial restructuring challenge that tested DCG's entire financial team.

GRAYSCALE'S LEGAL BATTLE — THE CASE THAT CHANGED EVERYTHING



Grayscale won the legal battle but lost the commercial war — their court victory forced the SEC to approve all Bitcoin ETFs, including the cheaper BlackRock and Fidelity products that then drained GBTC of assets.

BITCOIN HOLDING HISTORY

- ▲ **BUY** Sep 2013 · First BTC purchased · \$~\$100/BTC · Total: Small initial — *Grayscale Bitcoin Investment Trust launches as private placement.*
- ▲ **BUY** 2015–2020 · Continuous accumulation · \$200–\$10,000/BTC · Total: Growing — *Only regulated US Bitcoin vehicle. Slow but steady institutional demand.*
- ▲ **BUY** 2020–2021 · Massive inflows · \$10,000–\$65,000/BTC · Total: Peak: \$40B AUM — *Institutional FOMO during COVID bull market. Peak 650,000 BTC held.*
- ▼ **SELL** Jan–Mar 2024 · ~200,000 BTC outflows · \$40,000–\$65,000/BTC · Total: \$13B+ out — *ETF conversion triggers massive outflows to cheaper BlackRock & Fidelity products.*
- ▼ **SELL** 2024–2025 · Further redemptions · \$Varied/BTC · Total: Ongoing — *Continued slow bleed as IBIT and FBTC attract new institutional money.*
- ◆ **NOTE** May 2026 · ~220,000 BTC remaining. Still the third-largest Bitcoin ETF by holdings. Fee reduced to 1.5% from 2%.

MARKET IMPACT

Grayscale's place in Bitcoin history is paradoxical. It was the institution that did more than any other to legitimise Bitcoin as an institutional asset class — and then its legal victory opened the market to competitors that took most of its assets. The irony is profound: without Grayscale's decade of trailblazing, and without its gutsy decision to sue the SEC, the spot Bitcoin ETF market that BlackRock and Fidelity now dominate would not exist.

CATEGORY 4

PUBLIC COMPANIES

CORPORATE BITCOIN TREASURIES

09 · Strategy Inc. · 10 · Tesla · 11 · MARA Holdings · 12 · Metaplanet · 13 · Strive · 14 · Block Inc.

ENTITY #09 · PUBLIC COMPANY · CATEGORY 4

Strategy Inc. (formerly MicroStrategy)

HOLDINGS	TOTAL SPENT	CURRENT VALUE	TICKER
843,738 BTC	\$33.1 Billion	~\$68 Billion	Nasdaq: MSTR
As of May 18, 2026	Avg: \$66,384/BTC	~\$35B unrealised gain	Renamed Strategy 2025

COMPANY BACKGROUND

Strategy Inc. — renamed from MicroStrategy in 2025 — is the most extraordinary corporate Bitcoin story in history. What began in 1989 as a modest business intelligence software company in Northern Virginia has been completely reimagined, over the course of six years, as the world's largest corporate Bitcoin treasury. As of May 18, 2026, Strategy holds 843,738 BTC — representing 4.25% of all Bitcoin that will ever exist — purchased at a total cost of \$33.1 billion, with an average acquisition price of \$66,384 per Bitcoin.

The transformation began on August 11, 2020, when then-CEO Michael Saylor announced that MicroStrategy had converted \$250 million of its corporate cash reserves into Bitcoin — not as a speculation, but as a deliberate long-term treasury strategy. The rationale was simple and devastating in its logic: cash held in a bank earns near-zero interest and loses value to inflation, while Bitcoin is a finite, scarce asset with a mathematically guaranteed supply cap of 21 million coins. Saylor called it 'digital gold' and then went further: he engineered a financial structure — issuing convertible bonds and preferred stock — that allowed Strategy to continuously borrow money at low interest rates to buy more Bitcoin. The strategy has returned over 2,000% to shareholders since August 2020.

8 KEY PEOPLE — FULL BIOGRAPHIES

Michael J. Saylor

Executive Chairman & Co-Founder — The Bitcoin Prophet

Michael Jeffrey Saylor was born on February 4, 1965, in Lincoln, Nebraska, the son of an United States Air Force Chief Master Sergeant. Growing up on Air Force bases around the world gave Saylor early exposure to discipline, structure, and a deep sense of American institutional values. His family eventually settled near Wright-Patterson Air Force Base in Dayton, Ohio. A brilliant student, he graduated high school as valedictorian and class marshal, voted 'most likely to succeed.' In 1983, Saylor enrolled at the Massachusetts Institute of Technology on a full Air Force ROTC scholarship, pursuing dual degrees in Aeronautics and Astronautics and Science, Technology and Society, graduating with honours in 1987. He had planned to become an Air Force pilot — a career that ended before it began when a routine medical examination discovered a heart murmur that disqualified him from flight status. That redirection changed the history of corporate finance. During his senior year at MIT, Saylor secured a consulting contract with DuPont worth \$250,000 to develop computer simulations. With this funding, and alongside MIT classmate Sanju Bansal, he co-founded MicroStrategy in 1989. The company grew rapidly by providing business intelligence software to corporations including McDonald's and Visa. MicroStrategy went public in June 1998, its stock doubled on the first trading day, and by early 2000, Saylor's net worth had reached an estimated \$7 billion — making him the wealthiest man in the Washington DC area. Then disaster struck. On March 20, 2000, MicroStrategy announced it would restate its financial results for the previous two years due to accounting irregularities in how it recognised software revenues. The stock collapsed 62% in a single day, from \$333 to \$120. The SEC charged Saylor and two other executives with civil accounting fraud. Saylor settled in December 2000, paying \$350,000 in penalties and disgorging \$8.3 million — without admitting wrongdoing. His net worth fell by \$6 billion. He spent the next fifteen years rebuilding quietly. Then in the spring of 2020, during COVID lockdowns, Saylor spent months reading about Bitcoin with the intensity of a man who had spent decades waiting for an intellectual revelation. He later described his Bitcoin conversion as like 'discovering fire.' On July 22, 2020, he tweeted: 'Bitcoin is a swarm of cyber hornets serving the goddess of wisdom, feeding on the fire of truth, forging the land of the mind.' The Bitcoin community, knowing little of Saylor at this point, mostly dismissed it as eccentric. Six weeks later, he put \$250 million of company money into Bitcoin. He has never stopped. He resigned as CEO in August 2022 to become Executive Chairman, focusing entirely on Bitcoin strategy and advocacy. He tweets about Bitcoin approximately 10-20 times per day. His personal Bitcoin holdings are estimated at over 17,000 BTC. He has never married.

Phong Le

President & Chief Executive Officer

Phong Le joined MicroStrategy in 2015 and served as CFO and COO before becoming President in July 2020 and CEO in August 2022 when Saylor stepped down. Le manages Strategy's day-to-day operations including its core business intelligence software business — which still generates cash flow and is critical for maintaining Strategy's status as an operating company rather than an investment fund. Before MicroStrategy, he was CFO at XO Communications and held multiple VP positions at NII Holdings. He is the operational steady hand that allows Saylor to focus exclusively on Bitcoin acquisition and advocacy.

Andrew Kang

Executive Vice President & Chief Financial Officer

Andrew Kang is the financial architect who executes Strategy's complex Bitcoin financing programme. Under his direction, Strategy has issued multiple series of convertible notes totalling billions of dollars, at-the-market equity programmes, and several classes of preferred stock instruments — STRK, STRF, STRD, and STRC. Each instrument is designed to attract a different category of investor: convertible note buyers get bond-like downside protection with Bitcoin upside optionality; preferred stock buyers get fixed income; equity buyers get pure Bitcoin beta. The combined result is a machine that continuously converts Wall Street capital into Bitcoin.

Sanju Bansal

Co-Founder (former COO, Board Member)

Sanju Bansal met Michael Saylor at MIT and co-founded MicroStrategy in 1989. He served as COO for nearly two decades before stepping back from day-to-day operations. As a co-founder and long-term significant shareholder, Bansal has benefited enormously from Strategy's Bitcoin transformation — his stake is now worth hundreds of millions of dollars more than it would have been had the company remained a conventional software business.

Ponna Arumugam

Chief Technology Officer

Ponna Arumugam became CTO in January 2025 after previously serving as Chief Information Officer since 2018. He holds a degree in Electrical Engineering from Lehigh University and has previous experience at HCL Technologies and Unisys. As CTO, he oversees both the enterprise analytics software product that generates Strategy's operating revenue and the Bitcoin custody and treasury management technology systems that track and secure Strategy's 843,738 BTC holdings.

W. Ming Shao

Executive Vice President, General Counsel & Secretary

Ming Shao serves as Strategy's chief legal officer, overseeing SEC compliance for a company with one of the most complex public reporting structures in US markets — including common equity, multiple preferred stock series, and convertible debt, all of which have reporting obligations and interconnected accounting treatments under FASB's ASU 2023-08 fair value accounting rules for crypto assets.

Frederick Petri

Lead Independent Director, Board of Directors

Frederick Petri serves as lead independent director on Strategy's board, providing governance oversight of the company's Bitcoin strategy from the perspective of independent fiduciaries responsible to all shareholders. His role became more significant as Strategy's Bitcoin holdings grew to represent essentially the entirety of the company's market value.

Jarrold Patten

Chief Investment Officer (Bitcoin Treasury)

Jarrold Patten manages Strategy's Bitcoin treasury operations, including the execution of Bitcoin purchases, custody arrangements, and the tracking of the company's accumulation metrics including Bitcoin yield, Bitcoin gain, and Bitcoin dollar gain — the proprietary performance metrics Strategy uses to evaluate its treasury strategy.

COMPLETE BITCOIN PURCHASE HISTORY — NEVER SOLD (EXCEPT ONCE)

Strategy has sold Bitcoin exactly once in its history: 704 BTC in December 2022 for tax loss harvesting purposes. Every other transaction has been a purchase. The following is the most complete publicly available record of Strategy's Bitcoin accumulation:

▲ **BUY** Aug 11, 2020 · 21,454 BTC · \$11,652/BTC · Total: \$250M — *FIRST EVER PURCHASE — corporate treasury announcement*

▲ **BUY** Sep 14, 2020 · 16,796 BTC · \$9,882/BTC · Total: \$175M — *Second purchase — strategy confirmed permanently*

▲ **BUY** Dec 21, 2020 · 29,646 BTC · \$21,925/BTC · Total: \$650M — *Funded by \$650M 0.75% convertible notes*

▲ **BUY** Feb 24, 2021 · 19,452 BTC · \$52,765/BTC · Total: \$1.026B — *Largest single-day buy at the time, funded by \$1.05B stock offering*

▲ **BUY** Jun 21, 2021 · 13,005 BTC · \$37,617/BTC · Total: \$489M — *Funded by \$500M senior secured notes*

▲ **BUY** Aug–Sep 2021 · 8,957 BTC · \$~46,875/BTC · Total: \$420M — *Multiple purchases across two months*

▲ **BUY** Q4 2021 · 7,002 BTC · \$~52,765/BTC · Total: \$414M

▼ **SELL** Dec 2022 · 704 BTC · \$17,800/BTC · Total: \$12.5M SOLD — *ONLY SELL — tax loss harvesting. Bought back within days.*

▲ **BUY** Full year 2023 · ~56,650 BTC · \$~28,000–43,000/BTC · Total: ~\$1.6B — *Accumulation through bear market. Conviction never wavered.*

▲ **BUY** Q1 2024 · ~32,000 BTC · \$~43,000–68,000/BTC · Total: ~\$1.6B — *Pre-halving acceleration*

▲ **BUY** Nov 25, 2024 · 55,500 BTC · \$97,297/BTC · Total: \$5.4B — *LARGEST SINGLE WEEK BUY — post-election Bitcoin surge*

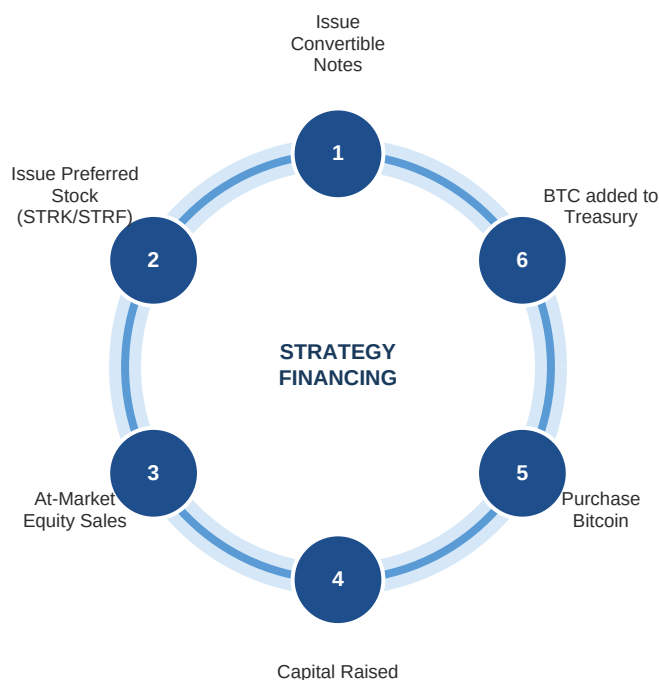
▲ **BUY** Dec 2024 · ~100,000 BTC · \$~95,000/BTC · Total: ~\$9.5B — *Extraordinary accumulation pace. December alone: ~\$9.5B*

▲ **BUY** Q1 2025 · ~89,000 BTC · \$~85,000–95,000/BTC · Total: ~\$7.6B — *Crosses 500,000 BTC milestone*

▲ **BUY** Apr 20, 2026 · 34,164 BTC · \$74,395/BTC · Total: \$2.54B — *Most recent disclosed purchase*

◆ **NOTE** May 18, 2026 · 843,738 BTC TOTAL · Avg: \$66,384 · Total: \$33.1B spent · Current confirmed holdings

HOW STRATEGY FINANCES ITS BITCOIN PURCHASES — DIAGRAM



Strategy has turned its Nasdaq listing into a Bitcoin accumulation engine. Four different financial instruments feed capital into a single output: more Bitcoin.

MARKET IMPACT

Strategy's Bitcoin strategy is the most influential corporate template in the history of digital assets. At least 40 public companies globally have adopted elements of Saylor's playbook. Strategy's weekly purchase announcements are closely tracked by the entire crypto market — each disclosure typically provides a short-term positive price signal. With 4.25% of all Bitcoin ever to exist in its treasury, Strategy has become structurally important to Bitcoin's market: any forced selling would be catastrophic, while continued accumulation provides a persistent demand floor.

ENTITY #10 · PUBLIC COMPANY · CATEGORY 4

Tesla, Inc.

HOLDINGS	USD VALUE	PEAK HOLDING	TICKER
~11,509 BTC	~\$930 Million	43,200 BTC	Nasdaq: TSLA
As of Q4 2025	At ~\$81,000/BTC	February 2021	EV & Energy

COMPANY BACKGROUND

Tesla, Inc. is the world's leading electric vehicle company and one of the most valuable corporations on Earth, founded in July 2003 by Martin Eberhard and Marc Tarpenning. Elon Musk joined as Chairman of the Board in 2004 after leading the Series A funding round, later becoming CEO in 2008. The company went public on June 29, 2010, and has since transformed from a startup into a \$1 trillion+ enterprise that has reshaped the global automotive, energy storage, and AI industries. Tesla's Bitcoin story is one of the most dramatic, controversial, and ultimately unresolved in the corporate world — a billion-dollar bet made and partially unwound within the span of 18 months, driven entirely by the mercurial judgment of one man: Elon Musk.

8 KEY PEOPLE — FULL BIOGRAPHIES

Elon Musk

CEO & Technoking of Tesla — The Most Influential Voice in Crypto Markets

Elon Reeve Musk was born on June 28, 1971, in Pretoria, South Africa, to Maye Musk, a model and dietitian, and Errol Musk, an electromechanical engineer and property developer. His childhood in apartheid South Africa was not easy — he has described being severely bullied at school. He taught himself to code at age 10 and sold his first video game, Blastar, to a computer magazine for \$500 at age 12. At 17, he moved to Canada to attend Queen's University in Ontario, then transferred to the University of Pennsylvania, where he earned dual bachelor's degrees in Economics from Wharton and Physics. He enrolled in a Stanford University PhD programme in energy physics in 1995 — and dropped out after two days to start a company. That company, Zip2, was acquired by Compaq for \$307 million in 1999, netting Musk \$22 million. He immediately reinvested in X.com, an online financial services company that merged with Confinity in 2000 to become PayPal, which was acquired by eBay in 2002 for \$1.5 billion. Musk received \$165 million from that sale, which he invested in three companies simultaneously: SpaceX (2002), Tesla (2004), and SolarCity (2006). He nearly went bankrupt in 2008 when both SpaceX and Tesla were on the brink of failure simultaneously. Both survived. SpaceX became the world's leading commercial rocket company. Tesla became the world's most valuable car company. Musk's relationship with Bitcoin is complicated and consequential. He began publicly discussing Bitcoin in 2019 and built a massive public platform on Twitter/X, which he acquired in October 2022 for \$44 billion. His tweets about Bitcoin and Dogecoin have moved cryptocurrency markets by 10-30% in minutes. He personally holds Bitcoin (estimated 9,000+ BTC), Dogecoin, and Ethereum. He joined the Trump administration in 2025 as head of the Department of Government Efficiency (DOGE) before departing to focus on his companies. His personal net worth has oscillated between \$150 billion and \$450 billion, making him at various points the wealthiest person in history.

Vaibhav Taneja

Chief Financial Officer

Vaibhav Taneja became Tesla's CFO in August 2023, succeeding Zachary Kirkhorn. He joined Tesla in 2017 as Corporate Controller after years at PricewaterhouseCoopers. As CFO, he manages Tesla's balance sheet which includes the approximately 11,509 BTC remaining on the company's books. He has navigated the significant FASB accounting changes for crypto assets (ASU 2023-08), which now requires fair value accounting for Bitcoin holdings rather than the prior impairment-only model.

Robyn Denholm

Chairman of the Board

Robyn Denholm is an Australian technology executive who has served as Tesla's Board Chairman since November 2018, replacing Musk in that role after SEC pressure following his controversial 'funding secured' tweet. She was previously CFO of Telstra, Australia's largest telecoms company. As Chairman, she is the formal governance check on Musk's sometimes impulsive corporate decisions, including the Bitcoin investment.

Drew Baglino

Former SVP Powertrain & Energy Engineering (departed 2024)

Drew Baglino was one of Tesla's longest-serving and most senior technical executives, leading the development of Tesla's battery technology and energy products. He departed Tesla in April 2024 amid a broader round of executive departures. As a senior executive during Tesla's Bitcoin investment period, he was part of the leadership team that executed the \$1.5 billion Bitcoin purchase in 2021.

Zachary Kirkhorn

Former CFO (2019–2023), 'Master of Coin'

Zachary Kirkhorn served as Tesla's CFO from March 2019 to August 2023 and was humorously given the title 'Master of Coin' by Musk at Tesla's 2021 shareholder meeting — a Bitcoin reference. He oversaw both the initial \$1.5 billion Bitcoin purchase and the subsequent decisions to sell 75% of holdings. He left Tesla in 2023 for undisclosed personal reasons.

Martin Viecha

Head of Investor Relations

Martin Viecha manages Tesla's communications with institutional investors and analysts, including handling questions about Tesla's Bitcoin position during quarterly earnings calls. Explaining Tesla's Bitcoin strategy — buy, partially sell, partially hold — to traditional automotive sector analysts who were mostly confused by the decision required considerable diplomatic skill.

James Murdoch

Board Director

James Murdoch, son of Rupert Murdoch and former CEO of 21st Century Fox, serves on Tesla's board. He has been one of the more visible Tesla board members on governance matters, including the ongoing questions around executive compensation and strategic decisions.

Larry Ellison

Board Director — Oracle Co-Founder

Larry Ellison, co-founder and CTO of Oracle Corporation and the sixth-wealthiest person in the world, joined Tesla's board in December 2022. A close personal friend of Musk's, Ellison is a Bitcoin holder himself and brings immense tech industry credibility to Tesla's board composition.

BITCOIN PURCHASE & SELL HISTORY — THE FULL STORY

Tesla's Bitcoin history is a case study in how one man's changing opinion can create and destroy billions of dollars in value, and how corporate Bitcoin strategy can be compromised by public communications and reputational concerns.

▲ **BUY** Feb 8, 2021 · 43,200 BTC · \$34,722/BTC · Total: \$1.5B — *Announced in SEC filing. Bitcoin surges 20% immediately. Musk adds #Bitcoin to his Twitter bio.*

◆ **NOTE** Mar 2021 · Tesla briefly accepts Bitcoin as payment for vehicles.

▼ **SELL** May 13, 2021 · ~4,320 BTC (10%) · \$~54,000/BTC · Total: ~\$234M — *Musk announces Tesla sold 10% to 'prove liquidity.' Market drops 17%. Community outrage.*

◆ **NOTE** May 2021 · Musk suspends Bitcoin vehicle payments citing 'environmental concerns' about Bitcoin mining energy use.

▼ **SELL** Jul 2022 · ~29,000 BTC (75% of remaining) · \$~32,000/BTC · Total: \$936M — *Tesla sells 75% of Bitcoin holdings during bear market. Musk says 'not a verdict on BTC.'*

◆ **NOTE** Q3 2022 · Tesla retains ~11,509 BTC. No further changes disclosed since.

◆ **NOTE** May 2026 · 11,509 BTC on balance sheet. Worth ~\$930M. No announced buying or selling plans.

MARKET IMPACT

Tesla's Bitcoin impact is entirely disproportionate to its relatively modest 11,509 BTC holding. The company's influence operates through Elon Musk's social media presence, which remains one of the single most powerful market-moving forces in crypto. A single Musk tweet has historically moved Bitcoin's price by 10-30% in minutes — a phenomenon with no parallel in any other asset class. Tesla's 2021 announcement normalised corporate Bitcoin treasury adoption for smaller companies globally, contributing to the cascade of corporate treasury announcements that followed.

ENTITY #11 · PUBLIC COMPANY / MINER · CATEGORY 4

MARA Holdings, Inc. (formerly Marathon Digital)

HOLDINGS	USD VALUE	MARKET CAP	MINING OPS
~46,000+ BTC	~\$3.7 Billion	~\$5 Billion	4 Continents
Mine and hold strategy	At ~\$81,000/BTC	Nasdaq: MARA	1,700 MW capacity

COMPANY BACKGROUND

MARA Holdings — formerly Marathon Digital Holdings — is one of the world's largest publicly traded Bitcoin mining companies and a uniquely positioned Bitcoin treasury company. Originally incorporated in 2012 as a patent holding company with no connection to crypto, MARA pivoted to Bitcoin mining in 2017 when CEO Merrick Okamoto identified it as a high-growth opportunity. Under the leadership of Fred Thiel — who joined the board in 2018 and became CEO in 2021 — MARA has grown from a company worth under \$30 million to a \$5 billion global operation spanning four continents with 15 data centres and 1,700 megawatts of energy capacity.

MARA's defining strategic decision was adopting a 'mine and hold' policy — unlike most mining companies that sell their mined Bitcoin daily to cover operating expenses, MARA retains the vast majority of its mined coins and supplements mining with direct market purchases financed through convertible notes and at-the-market equity offerings, following Strategy's playbook. This approach has made MARA simultaneously a mining operation and a de-facto leveraged Bitcoin ETF.

8 KEY PEOPLE — FULL BIOGRAPHIES

Fred Thiel

Chairman of the Board & Chief Executive Officer

Fred Thiel is one of the most experienced technology executives in the Bitcoin mining industry, bringing over 35 years of global technology leadership to MARA. He attended the Stockholm School of Economics and completed executive education at Harvard Business School. He is fluent in English, Spanish, Swedish, and French — reflecting a genuinely international career. Before MARA, Thiel served as CEO of two publicly listed technology companies: Local Corporation (Nasdaq: LOCM), a digital media and advertising company, and Lantronix, Inc. (Nasdaq: LTRX), an IoT and device networking company. He has successfully raised billions in equity and debt through public and private offerings, led companies through IPOs, and executed high-value M&A transactions throughout his career. Thiel joined MARA's board of directors in 2018 when the company was a struggling patent holding firm worth under \$30 million. Working with then-CEO Merrick Okamoto, he helped craft the strategy to pivot into Bitcoin mining. When Okamoto announced his retirement in 2021, Thiel stepped up as CEO and immediately accelerated MARA's transformation. Under his leadership in just three years, MARA grew from a \$30 million market cap to over \$5 billion. He has become one of the most respected voices in Bitcoin mining, frequently quoted on Bloomberg TV, CNBC, and Fox Business. Thiel is active in Young Presidents' Organisation (YPO) and serves as Chairman of Oden Technology, an IoT company. His strategy mirrors Michael Saylor's in conviction but is differentiated by its operational Bitcoin mining component.

Salman Khan

Chief Financial Officer

Salman Khan serves as MARA's CFO, managing the complex financial engineering required to support MARA's dual identity as a mining operator and Bitcoin treasury company. He oversees the issuance of the convertible notes and at-the-market equity programmes that finance Bitcoin purchases beyond what mining generates. In 2024, MARA launched a \$1.5 billion at-the-market offering programme and sold \$1 billion in zero-coupon convertible notes specifically to fund additional Bitcoin accumulation.

Adam Swick

Chief Mining Officer

Adam Swick leads MARA's global mining operations across its 15 data centres on four continents. He oversees the technical operation of MARA's Bitcoin mining infrastructure, optimising hash rate, energy efficiency, and uptime across facilities in the United States, United Arab Emirates, and Paraguay. His team's efficiency directly impacts MARA's cost per Bitcoin mined — the fundamental unit economics of the mining treasury strategy.

Merrick Okamoto

Former CEO & Co-Architect of MARA's Strategy

Merrick Okamoto served as MARA's CEO from 2018 until his retirement in 2021, working alongside Thiel to engineer MARA's transformation from a failed patent company into a Bitcoin mining operation. His initial vision of pivoting MARA into Bitcoin mining was the foundational decision that made everything that followed possible. He retired with the company in dramatically better shape than he found it, having guided it through its initial public mining buildout.

Robert Samuels

Chief Operating Officer

Robert Samuels manages MARA's operational infrastructure globally, overseeing the construction, commissioning, and daily operation of data centres across multiple jurisdictions with different regulatory environments, power sources, and operational challenges. His work includes managing MARA's renewable energy partnerships, which have become an increasing focus as the company addresses environmental criticism of Bitcoin mining.

Matthew Schultz

Executive Chairman

Matthew Schultz serves as Executive Chairman of MARA's board, providing strategic oversight and governance alongside Fred Thiel. His role focuses on board-level decision-making about capital allocation, financing strategy, and major strategic partnerships for the company's global expansion.

Jay Leupp

Lead Independent Director

Jay Leupp serves as MARA's lead independent director, providing governance oversight of the company's Bitcoin-centric strategy from an independent fiduciary perspective. His role has grown in importance as MARA's Bitcoin holdings have grown to represent a multi-billion dollar position requiring careful treasury management oversight.

Soo Soo Yow

VP of Finance & Principal Accounting Officer

Soo Soo Yow oversees MARA's detailed financial accounting, including the fair value accounting for Bitcoin holdings required under FASB's ASU 2023-08 rules. This accounting framework creates significant income statement volatility as Bitcoin prices change — a challenge that requires both technical accounting expertise and careful investor communication.

BITCOIN HISTORY — MINE, BUY AND HOLD

◆ **NOTE** 2017–2018 · MARA pivots from patents to Bitcoin mining. First mining rigs purchased.

▲ **BUY** 2019–2020 · Mined BTC · \$56,000–\$12,000/BTC · Total: Operational — *Mining operations scale up. Policy: sell BTC to cover operating costs.*

▲ **BUY** Q4 2021 · ~1,000+ BTC purchased · \$50,000–\$65,000/BTC · Total: ~\$60M — *MARA begins holding mined BTC rather than selling immediately.*

▲ **BUY** 2022–2023 · Ongoing mining · \$Varied bear market/BTC · Total: Mine and hold — *Accumulates through crypto winter. Operations expand globally.*

▲ **BUY** Oct 2024 · ~6,000 BTC · \$63,000/BTC · Total: \$379M — *MARA launches \$1B zero-coupon convertible note to buy spot BTC.*

▲ **BUY** Nov 2024 · ~11,774 BTC · \$97,000/BTC · Total: \$1.14B — *Record single-month purchase. Following Strategy playbook.*

◆ **NOTE** May 2026 · ~46,000+ BTC in treasury. World's 2nd largest corporate miner-treasury. Operations on 4 continents.

MARKET IMPACT

MARA's significance extends beyond its treasury holdings. As one of the world's largest Bitcoin miners, it directly contributes to Bitcoin's network security and decentralisation. Its mine-and-hold strategy permanently removes mined Bitcoin from liquid circulation, providing a structural demand floor. As mining becomes more institutionalised and energy-competitive, MARA's model represents the future of publicly traded Bitcoin mining companies.

ENTITY #12 · PUBLIC COMPANY (JAPAN) · CATEGORY 4

Metaplanet Inc.

HOLDINGS	USD VALUE	STOCK	TARGET
~35,000+ BTC	~\$2.8 Billion	TSE: 3350	100,000 BTC
As of Q1 2026	At ~\$81,000/BTC	Tokyo Stock Exchange	By end of 2026

COMPANY BACKGROUND

Metaplanet Inc. is Japan's most spectacular corporate Bitcoin story — a failing hotel company that reinvented itself as Asia's answer to MicroStrategy and became one of the best-performing stocks on the Tokyo Stock Exchange almost overnight. Listed on the Tokyo Stock Exchange (TSE: 3350), Metaplanet had been struggling as a hospitality business when, in April 2024, CEO Simon Gerovich announced a complete strategic pivot: the company would adopt Bitcoin as its primary treasury reserve asset, following Michael Saylor's playbook almost exactly. The hotel subsidiary was liquidated in May 2024. A Bitcoin treasury company was born.

Japan's economic environment made this strategy particularly compelling. With interest rates hovering near zero for decades — and occasionally going negative — Japanese institutional investors have been starved for yield. By issuing yen-denominated bonds to purchase Bitcoin, Metaplanet exploits a structural carry trade: borrow yen at near-zero rates, buy Bitcoin which historically appreciates faster than the interest cost. The strategy has delivered extraordinary results. Revenue jumped 738% year-over-year in 2025, and Metaplanet's stock delivered approximately a 3,500% return from its Bitcoin pivot announcement to early 2026.

Metaplanet closed 2025 with 35,102 BTC, making it the fourth-largest public corporate Bitcoin holder globally. The company has outlined aggressive accumulation targets: 100,000 BTC by end of 2026 and 210,000 BTC — approximately 1% of total supply — by end of 2027. To fund this ambition, it has raised approximately \$255 million from global institutional investors and established Metaplanet Ventures and Metaplanet Asset Management subsidiaries to build out Japan's Bitcoin financial infrastructure.

8 KEY PEOPLE — FULL BIOGRAPHIES

Simon Morris Gerovich

Representative Director, President & CEO

Simon Gerovich is an American executive who has made Tokyo his home and career base for many years. He earned a degree in Applied Mathematics from Harvard University — a quantitative foundation perfectly suited to the financial engineering behind Metaplanet's Bitcoin strategy. After Harvard, he moved to Tokyo where he began his career as an equity derivatives trader at Goldman Sachs Japan, developing deep expertise in options, structured products, and Japan's unique financial markets. His Goldman Sachs derivatives background is directly visible in Metaplanet's innovative use of Bitcoin options as a revenue generation tool — a strategy that accounted for approximately 95% of the company's total revenue in 2025. In 2011, Gerovich co-founded Sparx Ventures, an early-stage venture capital firm based in Hong Kong focused on high-growth technology businesses across fintech and hospitality. He became Chairman of Metaplanet Inc. in 2015 when it was a struggling hotel company. Gerovich has been following Bitcoin since 2012 — and suffered personally from the Mt. Gox collapse in 2014, having lost coins on the Tokyo-based exchange that was hacked. Despite that early loss, he retained his conviction in Bitcoin's long-term value. In early 2024, facing a hotel business devastated by COVID's lingering effects and Japan's weak yen, Gerovich proposed the bold pivot: sell the hotel assets, recapitalize with Bitcoin, adopt a corporate Bitcoin standard. He presented it to the board as a structured financial strategy with clear metrics: Bitcoin per share as the primary KPI, mNAV (modified Net Asset Value) as the valuation framework, and Bitcoin yield as the performance measure. The board approved. The hotel was sold in May 2024. The transformation has exceeded all expectations. Gerovich has been confirmed as a speaker at the Bitcoin 2026 conference in Las Vegas — recognition of his status as one of the most consequential corporate Bitcoin adopters outside the United States.

Dylan LeClair

Head of Bitcoin Strategy

Dylan LeClair is Metaplanet's Head of Bitcoin Strategy, responsible for the analytical framework and market intelligence behind the company's accumulation decisions. He was previously one of the most respected independent Bitcoin analysts, known for deep on-chain data analysis and macro Bitcoin research. His hire reflected Metaplanet's commitment to building world-class Bitcoin financial expertise in-house rather than relying on external advisors.

Mark Yusko

Strategic Advisor (Morgan Creek Capital)

Mark Yusko is CEO and CIO of Morgan Creek Capital Management and a highly respected figure in institutional investment circles. His advisory relationship with Metaplanet provides access to global institutional investor networks and validates Metaplanet's strategy to Western institutional audiences who might otherwise be unfamiliar with a Japanese-listed company.

Eric Trump

Strategic Advisory Board Member

Eric Trump, son of President Donald Trump, joined Metaplanet's Strategic Advisory Board in early 2025. His appointment was a deliberate signal — associating Metaplanet with the most pro-Bitcoin political family in the world and generating significant media attention in the United States for a Tokyo-listed company that might otherwise have been unknown to American investors.

Lyle Waisman

Director & CFO, Metaplanet Treasury Corp.

Lyle Waisman serves as CFO of Metaplanet Treasury Corp., the subsidiary that manages Metaplanet's Bitcoin holdings and financing activities. He oversees the treasury operations, Bitcoin custody arrangements, and the accounting for Metaplanet's Bitcoin position under Japanese accounting standards.

Jason Fang

Director & COO

Jason Fang serves as COO of Metaplanet, overseeing operational execution of the company's Bitcoin strategy including the fundraising, investment, and subsidiary development activities across Metaplanet Ventures and Metaplanet Asset Management.

Nao Kanazawa

Director

Nao Kanazawa serves on Metaplanet's board of directors, bringing Japanese institutional perspective and corporate governance expertise to the company's strategic decisions. Her role is critical in navigating Japan's corporate governance requirements while pursuing the aggressive Bitcoin accumulation strategy.

Tomoaki Murakami

Corporate Auditor

Tomoaki Murakami serves as Metaplanet's corporate auditor, providing independent oversight of the company's financial controls and compliance with Japanese corporate governance standards as it manages an increasingly large Bitcoin treasury under public company rules.

BITCOIN ACQUISITION HISTORY

- ◆ **NOTE** Pre-2024 · Metaplanet is a failing hotel company. Simon Gerovich proposes the Bitcoin pivot.
- ▲ **BUY** Apr 2024 · ~117 BTC · \$~\$67,000/BTC · Total: ¥1 billion (~\$6.5M) — *FIRST EVER PURCHASE — official Bitcoin strategy announcement.*
- ◆ **NOTE** May 2024 · Hotel subsidiary formally liquidated. Full transformation to Bitcoin treasury company.
- ▲ **BUY** Jun–Dec 2024 · ~1,762 BTC (various) · \$~\$60,000–\$95,000/BTC · Total: ~\$107M — *Rapid accumulation using equity and bond issuances.*
- ▲ **BUY** Q1 2025 · ~5,075 BTC · \$~\$82,000–\$95,000/BTC · Total: ~\$430M — *Largest quarterly purchase yet. Bond and equity financing.*
- ▲ **BUY** Full year 2025 · ~35,102 BTC total by Dec 31 · \$Avg ~\$82,000/BTC · Total: ~\$2.9B total — *738% revenue growth. 4th largest public corporate Bitcoin holder.*
- ▲ **BUY** Q1 2026 · Ongoing accumulation · \$~\$75,000–\$95,000/BTC · Total: \$255M raised from institutions — *New institutional investors. 100,000 BTC target by end 2026.*

MARKET IMPACT

Metaplanet's significance is both financial and symbolic. Financially, it is the largest corporate Bitcoin holder in Asia and the fourth-largest globally. Symbolically, it demonstrates that Michael Saylor's playbook can work in any market, any currency, any jurisdiction. Japan's near-zero interest rate environment makes the yen-borrow Bitcoin-buy carry trade particularly powerful — and Metaplanet has executed it with extraordinary precision. Its Eric Trump advisory board appointment represents the intersection of American political Bitcoin advocacy and Japanese corporate Bitcoin adoption — a fascinating cultural and financial bridge.

ENTITY #13 · PUBLIC COMPANY · CATEGORY 4

Strive, Inc. (formerly Strive Asset Management)

HOLDINGS	USD VALUE	TICKER	STRATEGY
~14,557 BTC	~\$1.18 Billion	Nasdaq: ASST	Bitcoin Treasury
As of April 24, 2026	At ~\$81,000/BTC	Formerly SATA	Acquired Semler Scientific

COMPANY BACKGROUND

Strive, Inc. is a structured finance and institutional asset management company with a uniquely political origin story. Originally founded as Strive Asset Management in 2022 by Vivek Ramaswamy — the entrepreneur and politician who subsequently ran for US president in the 2024 Republican primary — Strive positioned itself as the anti-ESG investment firm: one that argued companies should focus exclusively on financial returns rather than environmental, social, and governance priorities. Strive launched its first ETF in August 2022 and grew to manage over \$2 billion in assets.

In 2024, Strive pivoted to a Bitcoin treasury strategy under CEO Matt Cole. In January 2026, Strive completed the acquisition of Semler Scientific — a medical device company that had adopted Bitcoin as its primary treasury reserve in 2024 — adding 5,048 BTC to its holdings in what it described as 'the first acquisition of a publicly traded Bitcoin treasury company.' As of April 24, 2026, Strive holds approximately 14,557 BTC — the tenth-largest public corporate Bitcoin holder globally. The company trades on Nasdaq under the ticker ASST.

8 KEY PEOPLE — FULL BIOGRAPHIES

Vivek Ramaswamy

Founder (departed for politics 2023)

Vivek Ramaswamy was born on August 9, 1985, in Cincinnati, Ohio, to Indian immigrant parents. He graduated summa cum laude from Harvard College in 2007 with a degree in Biology, then earned his JD from Yale Law School in 2013. Between Harvard and Yale, he worked at a hedge fund and then joined Roivant Sciences, a pharmaceutical company where he rose to President. He became CEO of Roivant at age 26. He founded Strive Asset Management in 2022 with the explicit mission of fighting 'woke capitalism' and ESG investing. His 2023 book Woke, Inc. became a bestseller. He ran for the Republican presidential nomination in 2024, finishing third in the Iowa caucuses before endorsing Donald Trump. He was then appointed co-head of the Department of Government Efficiency (DOGE) alongside Elon Musk in the Trump administration before departing to run for Ohio Governor. He no longer has a day-to-day role at Strive.

Matt Cole

Chairman & Chief Executive Officer

Matt Cole succeeded Ramaswamy as CEO and has driven Strive's transformation into a Bitcoin treasury company. Under his leadership, Strive acquired Semler Scientific, expanded its Bitcoin holdings to 14,557 BTC, and repositioned the company as 'the first publicly traded asset management Bitcoin treasury company.' Cole has articulated a clear philosophy: Bitcoin is the hurdle rate for all capital deployment decisions — meaning every investment Strive makes is evaluated against the alternative of simply buying more Bitcoin. He has overseen the creation of the True North research and education brand that promotes corporate Bitcoin adoption.

Jeff Walton

CEO of True North & Chief Risk Officer

Jeff Walton leads True North, Strive's research and media subsidiary focused on corporate Bitcoin education. He runs the 'Bitcoin for Business' summit series targeting CFOs, founders, and treasurers who want to understand how to implement a Bitcoin treasury strategy. His CRO role at Strive oversees the risk management framework for Strive's Bitcoin-centric portfolio.

Joe Burnett

VP of Bitcoin Strategy

Joe Burnett joined Strive following the Semler Scientific acquisition, having previously served as Director of Bitcoin Strategy at Semler. He is one of the most respected Bitcoin strategy analysts in the corporate adoption space, bringing deep analytical expertise in Bitcoin treasury metrics, financing structures, and shareholder communication.

Eric Semler

Independent Board Member

Eric Semler served as Chairman and Executive Chairman of Semler Scientific before it was acquired by Strive. He joined Strive's board as an independent director following the acquisition. His experience building Semler Scientific's Bitcoin treasury from scratch provides valuable institutional knowledge for Strive's continued accumulation strategy.

Anson Frericks

President

Anson Frericks was one of the co-founders of Strive Asset Management alongside Ramaswamy. Before founding Strive, he was a senior executive at Anheuser-Busch InBev. He played a central role in building Strive's initial ETF business and has been instrumental in the company's evolution from asset manager to Bitcoin treasury company.

Justin Danhof

Head of Corporate Governance

Justin Danhof leads Strive's corporate governance and shareholder engagement functions, overseeing Strive's activist approach to the companies it invests in through its ETFs — pushing them to drop ESG commitments and focus on shareholder returns. This governance philosophy is directly applied to Strive's own Bitcoin-first capital allocation strategy.

Rabih Bou Rashid

Chief Financial Officer

Rabih Bou Rashid manages Strive's financial strategy, including the preferred equity financing structures used to amplify Bitcoin accumulation. Strive's amplification ratio of 37.2% (with 97.7% from preferred equity) represents a sophisticated approach to leveraged Bitcoin exposure within a publicly traded corporate structure.

BITCOIN ACQUISITION HISTORY

◆ **NOTE** 2022–2023 · Strive Asset Management launches. Anti-ESG ETF focus. No Bitcoin treasury initially.

▲ **BUY** 2024 · Initial BTC purchases · \$\$55,000–\$65,000/BTC · Total: Initial position — *Strive pivots to Bitcoin treasury strategy under Matt Cole.*

▲ **BUY** May 2025 · Major purchase · \$\$94,000/BTC · Total: \$750M raised — *Raises \$750M specifically to buy Bitcoin. Strategy firmly established.*

▲ **BUY** Jan 13, 2026 · 5,048 BTC acquired · \$\$91,561/BTC · Total: Semler acquisition — *Acquires Semler Scientific. First acquisition of a public Bitcoin treasury company.*

▲ **BUY** Jan 28, 2026 · 333.89 BTC · \$\$89,851/BTC · Total: \$30M — *Additional market purchase post-acquisition.*

▲ **BUY** Apr 27, 2026 · ~789 BTC · \$\$82,000/BTC · Total: ~\$64M — *Latest purchase. Total holdings reach ~14,557 BTC.*

MARKET IMPACT

Strive's significance lies in its innovative acquisition model — rather than just buying Bitcoin on the open market, it has pioneered the acquisition of other Bitcoin treasury companies as a growth strategy. This approach, if widely replicated,

could accelerate the consolidation of corporate Bitcoin holdings and remove even more Bitcoin from liquid circulation. Its True North educational arm also plays a broader role in accelerating corporate Bitcoin adoption by teaching the strategy to businesses that haven't yet made the move.

ENTITY #14 · PUBLIC COMPANY · CATEGORY 4

Block, Inc. (formerly Square)

HOLDINGS	USD VALUE	TICKER	FOUNDED
~8,485 BTC	~\$690 Million	NYSE: SQ	2009
On balance sheet	At ~\$81,000/BTC	Block, Inc.	Jack Dorsey, St. Louis

COMPANY BACKGROUND

Block, Inc. — founded as Square in 2009 by Jack Dorsey and Jim McKelvey in St. Louis, Missouri — is a financial services and technology company that has positioned itself as the most Bitcoin-native major fintech company in the United States. Renamed Block in December 2021 (to reflect its focus on the blockchain), the company operates four major business units: Cash App (consumer payments and Bitcoin buying), Square (merchant payment terminals), Afterpay (buy-now-pay-later), and a Bitcoin mining hardware and infrastructure division that produces the Proto mining rig — custom Bitcoin mining hardware for individuals and businesses.

Block purchased its first Bitcoin in October 2020, adding \$50 million (4,709 BTC) to its corporate balance sheet at approximately \$10,617 per coin — citing it as 'an investment in a new form of money.' A second purchase of 3,318 BTC followed in February 2021. Unlike Tesla, Block has never sold any of its corporate Bitcoin holdings. The company's Cash App platform is also one of the largest retail Bitcoin buying services in the United States, generating billions in Bitcoin transaction revenue annually.

Jack Dorsey's personal Bitcoin maximalism — his belief that Bitcoin is the only legitimate cryptocurrency and will become the native currency of the internet — permeates Block's corporate culture and strategy in a way that is unique among large public companies. He has repeatedly stated he would quit everything to work on Bitcoin if the protocol needed his help.

8 KEY PEOPLE — FULL BIOGRAPHIES

Jack Dorsey

Block Head & Chairperson — Co-Founder

Jack Patrick Dorsey was born on November 19, 1976, in St. Louis, Missouri, the son of Tim Dorsey, who worked for a company that made mass spectrometers, and Marcia Smith, a housewife. Dorsey showed a precocious interest in how cities and their infrastructure worked from a very young age — he was fascinated by maps, dispatch systems, and the logistics of how things moved through urban environments. He taught himself to code at 14, writing dispatch software that is still used by some taxi companies. He attended the Missouri University of Science and Technology before transferring to New York University, which he left without graduating. In 2000, he had the idea for a social media service where people could share what they were doing in real time — a concept that would eventually become Twitter. In 2009, he co-founded Square with Jim McKelvey — his answer to a problem he witnessed firsthand when McKelvey lost a sale because he couldn't accept a credit card. The Square card reader that attached to a smartphone's headphone jack democratised payment acceptance for small businesses. Square went public in November 2015. Meanwhile, Dorsey returned to Twitter as CEO in 2015 after co-founder-CEO Dick Costolo resigned. He ran both companies simultaneously until resigning from Twitter in November 2021, handing over to Parag Agrawal, before Twitter was acquired by Elon Musk in October 2022. Dorsey's Bitcoin maximalism is deep, sincere, and long-standing. He has said Bitcoin 'sets the foundation for a global internet currency' and that he wishes he had focused exclusively on Bitcoin from the beginning. He does not believe in Ethereum or any other cryptocurrency as having comparable legitimacy. Block funds an annual \$10 million grant to Bitcoin open-source developers. He renamed Square to Block in December 2021 explicitly as a tribute to blockchain technology. In Q1 2026, Block shipped its first Proto Bitcoin mining units and announced Square merchants can now accept Bitcoin payments as easily as a card tap.

Amrita Ahuja

Chief Financial Officer

Amrita Ahuja is Block's CFO and one of Silicon Valley's most respected financial executives. She manages Block's balance sheet including its 8,485 BTC corporate treasury position and oversees the fair value accounting for those holdings under FASB's ASU 2023-08 rules. She also manages Block's extensive Bitcoin ecosystem business — Cash App's Bitcoin trading, the Proto mining hardware programme, and Square merchants' Bitcoin acceptance systems. Her certification of Block's most recent 10-Q filing alongside Jack Dorsey as principal financial officer gives her legal responsibility for the accuracy of Block's Bitcoin disclosures.

Jim McKelvey

Co-Founder & Board Director

Jim McKelvey is the co-founder of Square who dreamed up the original card reader with Jack Dorsey after a lost art glass sale. A glass artist and entrepreneur from St. Louis, McKelvey's moment of frustration at being unable to accept a credit card payment sparked one of Silicon Valley's most successful companies. He has stepped back from operations but remains on Block's board and is a significant shareholder.

Alyssa Henry

Former Seller Lead (Square) — departed 2023

Alyssa Henry led Square's seller business for many years, overseeing the merchant payment terminals and services that generate a significant portion of Block's revenue. Her departure in 2023 was part of a broader leadership restructuring as Dorsey consolidated oversight of Block's major business units.

Nick Molnar

Co-Founder & Co-CEO, Afterpay

Nick Molnar is the Australian entrepreneur who co-founded Afterpay with Anthony Eisen and brought the company to the US and global market. Block acquired Afterpay in January 2022 for \$29 billion in stock — the largest-ever acquisition of an Australian company. Molnar and Eisen have continued to lead Afterpay as a division of Block, integrating its buy-now-pay-later functionality into Cash App and Square merchant systems.

Brian Grassadonia

Former Cash App Lead — departed 2022

Brian Grassadonia was the head of Cash App for many years, overseeing its growth into one of America's most popular financial apps with over 50 million active users. Cash App's Bitcoin buying feature — which allows instant BTC purchases with zero withdrawal friction — has been one of the key drivers of Bitcoin adoption among younger American users. His leadership built the product that generates billions in annual Bitcoin transaction revenue for Block.

Jesse Dorogusker

Head of Hardware (Proto Bitcoin Miner)

Jesse Dorogusker leads Block's hardware division, which has developed the Proto — Block's custom Bitcoin mining rig designed to make Bitcoin mining accessible to individuals and small businesses rather than exclusively large industrial operations. The first Proto units shipped in Q4 2025 and Q1 2026. Dorsey has framed mining decentralisation as a key priority: the more people who mine Bitcoin, the more secure and decentralised the network becomes.

Sandhya Venkataraman

Chief People Officer

Sandhya Venkataraman oversees Block's human resources, culture, and talent strategy. Block's culture is unique among major tech companies: it is explicitly Bitcoin-first, values radical transparency, and has a distributed remote-first workforce policy. Maintaining and evolving that culture as Block grows internationally is the core challenge of her role.

BITCOIN ACQUISITION HISTORY

▲ **BUY** Oct 8, 2020 · 4,709 BTC · \$10,617/BTC · Total: \$50M — *First corporate Bitcoin purchase. 'An investment in a new form of money.'*

▲ **BUY** Feb 23, 2021 · 3,318 BTC · \$51,236/BTC · Total: \$170M — *Second and final direct market purchase. Total: 8,027 BTC.*

◆ **NOTE** Mar 2021 · Block NEVER sells corporate Bitcoin. All 8,027+ BTC retained through every market cycle.

◆ **NOTE** Dec 2021 · Company renamed from Square to Block. Bitcoin maximalism formally embedded in company name.

◆ **NOTE** 2022–2025 · Holdings grow slightly due to FASB accounting changes. Bitcoin ecosystem revenue grows. Cash App BTC buying accelerates.

◆ **NOTE** Q1 2026 · ~8,485 BTC on balance sheet. Proto mining unit launches. Square merchants can now accept Bitcoin payments.

MARKET IMPACT

Block's impact on Bitcoin adoption is operational rather than merely financial. Cash App's Bitcoin buying feature — simple, instant, and integrated into an app that millions of Americans use daily — has been one of the most effective onboarding tools for new Bitcoin buyers in the US market. The Proto mining rig represents Block's contribution to Bitcoin network decentralisation. Jack Dorsey's consistent, vocal, personal Bitcoin maximalism provides a counterpoint to Elon Musk's volatility — demonstrating that long-term Bitcoin conviction is possible from a major tech CEO without the mood swings.